intellectual property rights, and possibly new mechanisms for a single window clearance and faster resolution of nontariff barrier disputes.[176]

With respect to emerging cooperation in other areas of collective financial statecraft, surprises abound, particularly where they share common aversions. Thus, as previously noted, BRICS have individually (and as of 2016, collectively) agreed to evaluate the merits of establishing a BRICS credit rating agency to break the monopoly of the U.S. "Big Three"—Moody's, Fitch, and S&P—which together account for 90 percent of the global ratings market. The BRICS governments challenge the ratings of these private firms as Western-biased and insufficiently informed about their local conditions. Similarly, threats to shut off SWIFT as part of U.S. sanctions campaigns against Iran and others have been opposed by the BRICS. They add further justification for the creation of China's proposed CIPS, which is supported by Russia and is designed to work competitively, but also in collaboration with, not as a wholesale substitute for, the incumbent Western model.

CONCLUSION: MOSTLY SUCCESSFUL BRICS COLLECTIVE FINANCIAL STATECRAFT

This chapter has examined collective financial statecraft, focusing on the ways in which rising or middle powers might choose this medium to seek greater power and influence in the international system, specifically vis-à-vis a group of dominant incumbent powers. Four ideal types of collective financial statecraft were analyzed: inside reforms of institutions of global governance, the outside option of creating new global financial institutions, and both inside reforms and outside options to manipulate international financial markets, resist such manipulation by others, or acquire more power and influence within such markets.

In terms of the four cases, the key questions are whether the cooperation itself was a success, as well as whether the cooperative action succeeded in achieving the group's intended aims. The challenge of evaluating success and failure of the BRICS collective financial statecraft in these four cases arises not only from the fact that these cases are relatively new developments and most of them are still ongoing, but also from the time inconsistency challenge. That is, thus far none of these cases has been very costly for any of the BRICS countries. This makes cooperation much easier than otherwise would be the case, and they can all see that current commitments to cooperate have potentially large rewards. However, such commitments are less credible looking into the future, as costs may grow or benefits fail to materialize. This